

DION WILSON

Founder & Executive Director • Bitcoin For The Arts, Inc.

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Arts executive, nonprofit founder, and 16-year professional performing artist who danced principal roles with the Alvin Ailey American Dance Theater, Dance Theatre of Harlem, and Philadelphia Dance Company, and toured nationally with Disney's *The Lion King*. Now leading Bitcoin For The Arts — the first 501(c)(3) nonprofit paying artists exclusively in Bitcoin — combining deep arts-sector expertise with Bitcoin advocacy to build a new model of sovereign arts patronage. Princess Grace Fellowship recipient. Mentored 10,000+ students. Organized NYC Bitcoin community meetups. AGMA contract negotiator. ACE Certified Personal Trainer.

EXECUTIVE LEADERSHIP

Bitcoin For The Arts, Inc.

2025 – Present

Founder & Executive Director, Interim Board Chair • New York, NY

- Founded and lead the first 501(c)(3) nonprofit dedicated to funding artists exclusively in Bitcoin through micro-grants (\$500–\$25,000), workshops, residencies, and productions
- Built and oversee a 5-member founding board of directors spanning arts, finance, technology, and media
- Designed the 55/30/10/5 allocation model: 55% artist grants, 30% programs, 10% operations, 5% Bitcoin endowment (HODL Vault)
- Launched the Sovereign Circle membership program (5 tiers, \$5–\$101/month) for recurring donor revenue
- Directed publication of 8+ in-depth artist stories from 6 countries and produced 3 open-licensed video episodes
- Built custom open-source technology platform: grant application system, BTCPay Server integration, Nostr-compatible artist hub
- Published full governance framework: bylaws, conflict of interest policy, endowment management, code of ethics, curatorial manifesto
- Applied for DRK Foundation, Candid registration, and institutional partnerships to scale grant-making
- Organize the **Bitcoin Walk NYC** and **Bitcoin w/Coffee Meetup** in New York City, building arts + Bitcoin community
- Founded the NYC Group Chat on Club Orange, a Bitcoin social platform

PROFESSIONAL PERFORMING ARTS CAREER

Disney's The Lion King — National Tour

2007 – 2013

Ensemble Actor / Lead Male Dancer • US & Canada (20+ countries, 45 U.S. states)

- Performed 8 shows per week as dancer, singer, and actor across 6 years of national touring
- Elected Actors' Equity Association Union Representative — mediated between cast and management, enforced performer rights, reported to league office
- Represented the production at media engagements, patron Q&A sessions, and community outreach events

Fela! The Musical — Original Workshop

2007

Ensemble Actor • New York, NY

- Assisted in the development of the original workshop production (later Tony-nominated) by Bill T. Jones
- Performed and rehearsed as dancer, singer, and actor; assisted in fundraising events

Alvin Ailey American Dance Theater

2001 – 2006

Principal Dancer • New York, NY

- Performed principal roles in masterworks including Ailey's *Revelations*, *Blues Suite*, and *The River*
- Conducted master classes through outreach programs; represented the company at formal engagements

- Helped negotiate the AGMA contract — reformed the company pay scale for the first time since unionization
- Featured in PBS documentary "Beyond The Steps: Alvin Ailey American Dance Theater" (US & European tour)

Dance Theatre of Harlem

2000 – 2001

Dancer, Corps de Ballet • New York, NY

- Performed with the company; represented DTH at formal engagements and youth outreach

Philadelphia Dance Company (Philadanco)

1998 – 2000

Principal Dancer • Philadelphia, PA

- Performed principal roles; taught master classes at schools and universities while on tour
- Featured in PBS documentary "Free to Dance"

TEACHING & MENTORSHIP

10,000+ students mentored across the U.S. and abroad in ballet, modern, jazz, contemporary, musical theater, and dance appreciation. Select institutions:

- **American Ballet Theatre** — Summer Program Jazz Instructor (2014–2018)
- **Cleo Parker Robinson Dance** — Summer Intensive Faculty, Denver, CO (2017)
- **Broadway Connections** — Master Class / Workshop Instructor, nationwide (2008–2013)
- **Jazz at Lincoln Center** — Dance Appreciation Instructor, NYC (2014)
- **Philadelphia Dance Company** — Ballet & Composition, Breaking Barriers Summer Program (2014)
- **Towson University, University of Oklahoma, Boston Arts Academy, Baltimore School for the Arts, Detroit School of Arts, Alaska Dance Theatre, Long Island University, San Diego School of Creative and Performing Arts, Alvin Ailey Dance Center**
- Guest lecturer at **Booker T. Washington Performing & Visual Arts High School** and **Duke Ellington School of the Arts**

CHOREOGRAPHY

- **Debbie Allen Dance Academy** — "Day Dreams," Summer Program, Los Angeles (2003)
- **Alvin Ailey Dancers Resource Fund** — "Last Chance," benefit performance, NYC (2005)
- **Towson University** — "Day Dreams," student company (2006)
- **International Dance Festival, Spoleto, Italy** — performed original work
- **Kill Kill or Die** — Musical, choreographed all musical scenes, Denver (2011)
- **Helping Hand Foundation** — "One Plus One," benefit duet, Buffalo (2012)
- **Aaron Davis Hall** — Commissioned work, NYC

PHILANTHROPY & COMMUNITY

- Performed, directed, and choreographed for **Broadway Cares/Equity Fights AIDS** benefits supporting AIDS, breast cancer, and disaster relief
- Organizer, **Bitcoin Walk NYC** and **Bitcoin w/Coffee Meetup** — community events connecting artists and Bitcoin advocates
- Founder, **NYC Group Chat on Club Orange** — Bitcoin social platform community

AWARDS & RECOGNITION

Princess Grace Foundation Fellowship Award — Dance (1999)

Maryland State Arts Council Award — Solo Dance Performance (2000, 2003)

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

Bachelor of Fine Arts in Dance — SUNY at Purchase College (2001)

Baltimore School for the Arts — Dance Major

University of the Arts — Philadelphia, PA (attended)

ACE Certified Personal Trainer — American Council on Exercise (2014)

ACE Fitness Nutrition Specialist | **Pre/Post Natal Certified** | **ViPR Certified**

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS

Actors' Equity Association (AEA) — Former Union Representative, Disney's The Lion King

American Guild of Musical Artists (AGMA)

FITNESS & WELLNESS

Dbody Personal Wellness

2016 – Present

Founder • New York, NY

- Private personal training combining ballet/modern dance conditioning with functional fitness

Manhattan Athletic Club

2015 – Present

Personal Trainer / Group Fitness Instructor • New York, NY

- Train clients, conduct fitness assessments, teach barre and group fitness classes

Equinox — Printing House

2014 – 2016

Personal Trainer • New York, NY

- Programming, body composition analysis, daily educational training program